# ENGLISH
## in Different Situations

48 practical situations for everyday conversations









SHORT DIALOGUES / USEFUL PHRASES / ROLE-PLAY

Original black-and-white drawings. Calm colours. Language you can use.

Name: _____

# Welcome to the book

## A conversation companion

This book is for teen and adult learners who want practical English for everyday places. It uses short, original model conversations. Start with situations you need now; you do not have to read it from beginning to end.

## Inside every situation

One goal, a six-turn dialogue, three reusable phrases, four useful words and a role-play. The small scene drawings identify the chapter; the dialogue gives the specific situation.

## Two editions, one route

The English-only edition is for independent English practice. The English-Arabic edition places each English page beside its Arabic support page. Both editions use the same situation numbers and page numbers.

## How to use the Arabic support

Read the English first. Use the Arabic to check meaning, then cover it and speak in English. The Arabic is a natural translation; English and Arabic do not always use the same word order.

## Read, listen, speak

Read both parts aloud or ask a partner to read one. You may use a text-to-speech reader for the English. No separate audio recording is included. Swap roles and try again with new details.

## About the examples

Names, places, prices, schedules and service arrangements are fictional practice examples. Price figures use an unspecified currency unless a currency is named. Actual charges, policies and services vary. Medical scenes practise communication, not diagnosis or treatment.

## Made for practice

Written and prepared by Ms. Amina Qatan, 2026. All dialogues are original, with original AI-generated pen-and-ink-style illustrations. They are not copied from a published coursebook.

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# Phrases for almost anywhere

Learn each phrase as a whole. Use it whenever you need it.

**Excuse me.**

Get someone’s attention.

**Could you help me, please?**

Ask for help.

**Could you say that again?**

Ask for repetition.

**Could you speak more slowly?**

Ask for a slower pace.

**What does this mean?**

Check a word or instruction.

**Could you write it down?**

Check a name, number or address.

**Do you mean ...?**

Check your understanding.

**Let me check that I understand.**

Repeat the key information.

**I am not sure.**

Be honest when you do not know.

**Could I have a moment, please?**

Give yourself thinking time.

**Thank you for your help.**

Close politely.

**Have a good day.**

End a conversation warmly.

# Small practice. Real conversations.

## A 15-minute practice routine

1. Read the goal and look at the drawing.
2. Read the dialogue for meaning.
3. Say each part aloud with a partner or reader.
4. Cover the dialogue and use the role-play.
5. Change one detail, repeat, then note one phrase to keep.

## Practise in four weeks

Week 1: travel and hotels, situations 01–12.
Week 2: food and shopping, situations 13–24.
Week 3: health and services, situations 25–36.
Week 4: study, work and social life, situations 37–48.
Repeat any week if you need more practice.

## Make it sound natural

Use a friendly opening, a clear request and a polite closing. Pause after a question. Listen to the answer before asking another question. Aim to be understood, not to speak as fast as possible.

## Useful English varieties

This book mainly uses British English. You may also hear: lift / elevator; return ticket / round-trip ticket; bill / check in a restaurant; takeaway / takeout. Both forms can be useful.

## Your practice agreement

Use made-up contact and booking details during role-play. Agree who starts and then swap. Open-ended tasks have many possible answers; there is no single script you must memorise.

## My weekly plan

My practice days: _____
My partner or reader: _____
My first three situations: _____

# Travel & getting around



## In this chapter

01 Checking in at the airport

02 Finding your boarding gate

03 At passport control

04 Taking a taxi

05 Buying a bus or train ticket

06 Asking for directions

Look at the drawing. Where are the people? What might they say first?

# 01 Checking in at the airport



GOAL Check in for a flight and ask about your luggage.

## The conversation

| | |
|---|---|
| **Traveller** | Hello. I would like to check in for my flight to London. |
| **Agent** | Of course. May I see your passport and booking reference? |
| **Traveller** | Here you are. Can I check in this suitcase? |
| **Agent** | Yes. Please put it on the scale. Do you have a seat preference? |
| **Traveller** | An aisle seat, please. Which gate should I go to? |
| **Agent** | Gate twelve. Here is your boarding pass. Please check the screen for updates. |

## Keep these phrases

I would like to check in.

An aisle seat, please.

Which gate should I go to?

## Words to know

| | |
|---|---|
| **passport** | an official travel document |
| **boarding pass** | a document for boarding a flight |
| **aisle** | the space between seat rows |
| **scale** | a machine for weighing things |

### Your turn / 2 minutes

A: check in with one suitcase. Ask for a seat. B: ask for the booking details and give a gate number.

**Change it:** Change the destination, seat preference and gate.

SELF-CHECK I made my request clear / I responded / I checked details

# 02 Finding your boarding gate



GOAL Ask for airport directions and confirm boarding time.

## The conversation

| | |
|---|---|
| **Traveller** | Excuse me. Where is gate twenty-four? |
| **Airport staff** | Go straight ahead, then take the lift to the next floor. |
| **Traveller** | Is it a long walk from the lift? |
| **Airport staff** | No. Turn right when you come out. It is near the café. |
| **Traveller** | Thank you. What time does boarding start? |
| **Airport staff** | Your pass says ten thirty. Check the screen in case anything changes. |

## Keep these phrases

Where is gate twenty-four?

Is it a long walk?

What time does boarding start?

## Words to know

| | |
|---|---|
| **gate** | the place where passengers board |
| **lift** | a machine that moves between floors |
| **boarding** | getting onto a plane |
| **screen** | a display showing information |

### Your turn / 2 minutes

A: find a gate and ask about walking distance. B: give two directions and a boarding time.

**Change it:** Use a different floor and a different landmark.

SELF-CHECK I made my request clear / I responded / I checked details

# 03 At passport control



GOAL Answer simple questions about a visit.

## The conversation

| | |
|---|---|
| **Officer** | Good afternoon. May I see your passport, please? |
| **Visitor** | Certainly. Here it is. |
| **Officer** | What is the purpose of your visit? |
| **Visitor** | I am here on holiday. I am staying for one week. |
| **Officer** | Where will you be staying? |
| **Visitor** | At the Harbour Hotel. Here is my booking confirmation. |

## Keep these phrases

What is the purpose of your visit?

I am here on holiday.

I am staying for one week.

## Words to know

| | |
|---|---|
| **purpose** | the reason for doing something |
| **visit** | a short stay in a place |
| **confirmation** | proof that an arrangement is agreed |
| **holiday** | time away for rest or travel |

### Your turn / 2 minutes

A: ask about the purpose, length and location of a visit. B: answer using invented travel details.

**Change it:** Change the visit to a conference or a family visit.

SELF-CHECK I made my request clear / I responded / I checked details

# 04 Taking a taxi



GOAL Explain where you want to go and ask about payment.

## The conversation

| | |
|---|---|
| **Passenger** | Hello. Could you take me to the Central Hotel, please? |
| **Driver** | Certainly. Do you mean the one near the station? |
| **Passenger** | Yes, that is right. About how much will it cost? |
| **Driver** | The estimate is fifteen. It may be more if traffic is heavy. |
| **Passenger** | Can I pay by card? |
| **Driver** | Yes, you can. I can give you a receipt when we arrive. |

## Keep these phrases

Could you take me to ...?

About how much will it cost?

Can I pay by card?

## Words to know

| | |
|---|---|
| **fare** | the cost of a journey |
| **estimate** | an approximate amount |
| **traffic** | vehicles on the road |
| **receipt** | a record of payment |

### Your turn / 2 minutes

A: choose a destination and ask about the fare and payment. B: confirm the place and give a practice estimate.

**Change it:** Ask to stop at a pharmacy on the way.

SELF-CHECK I made my request clear / I responded / I checked details

# 05 Buying a bus or train ticket



GOAL Choose a ticket and ask where to board.

## The conversation

| | |
|---|---|
| **Passenger** | A return ticket to Greenford, please. |
| **Clerk** | Are you coming back today? |
| **Passenger** | Yes, this evening. When is the next train? |
| **Clerk** | At nine twenty, from platform three. |
| **Passenger** | Is this ticket valid for the evening service? |
| **Clerk** | Yes. Keep your ticket with you for both journeys. |

## Keep these phrases

A return ticket, please.

When is the next train?

Which platform is it?

## Words to know

| | |
|---|---|
| **return ticket** | a ticket for going and coming back |
| **platform** | the area beside a train track |
| **valid** | accepted for use |
| **journey** | travel from one place to another |

### Your turn / 2 minutes

A: buy a ticket and ask about the departure. B: ask single or return, then give a time and platform.

**Change it:** Use a bus, a single ticket and a bus stop number.

SELF-CHECK I made my request clear / I responded / I checked details

# 06 Asking for directions



GOAL Find a place and check that you understand the route.

## The conversation

| | |
|---|---|
| **Visitor** | Excuse me. Is there a pharmacy near here? |
| **Local resident** | Yes. Walk straight ahead and turn left at the bank. |
| **Visitor** | Is it opposite the supermarket? |
| **Local resident** | No, it is next to it, just before the traffic lights. |
| **Visitor** | So, left at the bank, then next to the supermarket? |
| **Local resident** | Exactly. It is about a five-minute walk. |

## Keep these phrases

Is there a … near here?

Could you show me on the map?

So, I turn left at …?

## Words to know

| | |
|---|---|
| **straight ahead** | forward without turning |
| **opposite** | on the other side facing something |
| **next to** | beside |
| **traffic lights** | lights that control road traffic |

### Your turn / 2 minutes

A: ask for a place and repeat the route. B: give directions using two landmarks.

**Change it:** Draw a small map and swap the destination.

SELF-CHECK I made my request clear / I responded / I checked details

# Hotels & accommodation



## In this chapter

07 Booking a hotel room

08 Checking in at a hotel

09 Requesting something for your room

10 Reporting a room problem

11 Checking out and leaving luggage

12 Asking about a room to rent

Look at the drawing. Where are the people? What might they say first?

# 07 Booking a hotel room



GOAL Ask about availability, price and what is included.

## The conversation

| | |
|---|---|
| **Guest** | Hello. Do you have a double room for two nights from Friday? |
| **Receptionist** | Yes, we do. It is sixty a night, including breakfast. |
| **Guest** | Is that the total price, including any taxes? |
| **Receptionist** | Yes. The total for two nights is one hundred and twenty. |
| **Guest** | I would like to book it. What is the cancellation policy? |
| **Receptionist** | Let me explain the terms before we confirm your booking. |

## Keep these phrases

Do you have a room available?

Is breakfast included?

What is the cancellation policy?

## Words to know

| | |
|---|---|
| **double room** | a room with a double bed |
| **available** | ready for someone to use |
| **included** | part of the stated price |
| **cancel** | to stop a planned booking |

### Your turn / 2 minutes

A: book a room for two people and ask about the total. B: offer a room and explain your invented cancellation terms.

**Change it:** Ask for a twin room with two separate beds.

SELF-CHECK I made my request clear / I responded / I checked details

# 08 Checking in at a hotel



GOAL Confirm your booking and ask about hotel facilities.

## The conversation

| | |
|---|---|
| **Guest** | Good evening. I have a reservation under the name Sami Ali. |
| **Receptionist** | Welcome. May I see your ID, please? |
| **Guest** | Of course. What time is breakfast? |
| **Receptionist** | From seven to ten in the dining room on the ground floor. |
| **Guest** | Thank you. How do I connect to the Wi-Fi? |
| **Receptionist** | The details are on your key-card holder. Your room is on the second floor. |

## Keep these phrases

I have a reservation under ...

What time is breakfast?

How do I connect to the Wi-Fi?

## Words to know

| | |
|---|---|
| **reservation** | an arrangement to keep a room for you |
| **ID** | a document showing who you are |
| **ground floor** | the floor at street level |
| **key card** | a card used to open a door |

### Your turn / 2 minutes

A: check in and ask two questions. B: confirm the name, then explain breakfast and the room location.

**Change it:** Ask where the lift and the restaurant are.

SELF-CHECK I made my request clear / I responded / I checked details

# 09 Requesting something for your room



GOAL Make a clear and polite request to reception.

## The conversation

| | |
|---|---|
| **Guest** | Hello. This is room two hundred and six. Could I have an extra blanket? |
| **Receptionist** | Certainly. Would you like an extra pillow as well? |
| **Guest** | Yes, please. Could you send two towels too? |
| **Receptionist** | Of course. We can bring them up shortly. |
| **Guest** | Thank you. Should I wait in the room? |
| **Receptionist** | Yes, please. We will knock when we arrive. |

## Keep these phrases

Could I have an extra ...?

Could you send ... to my room?

Should I wait here?

## Words to know

| | |
|---|---|
| **blanket** | a warm bed covering |
| **pillow** | a soft support for your head |
| **towel** | a cloth for drying yourself |
| **shortly** | soon |

## Your turn / 2 minutes

A: request two items for a room. B: confirm the room number and say when you can bring them.

**Change it:** Ask for a hairdryer or drinking water instead.

SELF-CHECK I made my request clear / I responded / I checked details

# 10 Reporting a room problem



GOAL Describe a problem and ask for a practical solution.

## The conversation

| | |
|---|---|
| **Guest** | Hello. The air conditioning in my room is not working. |
| **Receptionist** | I am sorry about that. What is your room number? |
| **Guest** | Three hundred and twelve. The room is very warm. |
| **Receptionist** | I will contact maintenance. May someone come to check it now? |
| **Guest** | Yes. If it cannot be fixed, could I move to another room? |
| **Receptionist** | I will check availability and let you know. |

## Keep these phrases

The ... is not working.

Could someone check it?

Could I move to another room?

## Words to know

| | |
|---|---|
| **air conditioning** | a system that cools indoor air |
| **maintenance** | work to keep things working |
| **fix** | to repair |
| **availability** | whether something is free to use |

### Your turn / 2 minutes

A: report a room problem and explain its effect. B: apologise and offer a first step.

**Change it:** Change the problem to a broken light or a noisy room.

SELF-CHECK I made my request clear / I responded / I checked details

# 11 Checking out and leaving luggage



GOAL Check your bill and arrange to collect your bags later.

## The conversation

| | |
|---|---|
| **Guest** | I would like to check out, please. Could I see the bill? |
| **Receptionist** | Certainly. Please check the charges before you pay. |
| **Guest** | Everything looks right. Could you email me a receipt? |
| **Receptionist** | Of course. Please confirm your email address. |
| **Guest** | Can I leave my luggage here until four o'clock? |
| **Receptionist** | Yes. We will give you a luggage tag. Please bring it when you collect your bags. |

## Keep these phrases

Could I see the bill?

Could you email me a receipt?

Can I leave my luggage here?

## Words to know

| | |
|---|---|
| **bill** | a list of amounts to pay |
| **charge** | an amount you must pay |
| **luggage tag** | a label used to identify a bag |
| **collect** | to come and take something |

### Your turn / 2 minutes

A: check out and ask to leave bags. B: explain the bill and give a collection time.

**Change it:** Notice one charge you do not recognise and ask about it.

SELF-CHECK I made my request clear / I responded / I checked details

# 12 Asking about a room to rent



GOAL Ask about rent, bills and viewing a room.

## The conversation

| | |
|---|---|
| **Renter** | Hello. I am calling about the room you advertised. Is it still available? |
| **Owner** | Yes. It is furnished and available from next month. |
| **Renter** | How much is the rent, and are bills included? |
| **Owner** | The rent is three hundred a month. Electricity is separate. |
| **Renter** | Could I arrange a viewing before I decide? |
| **Owner** | Certainly. Would Saturday morning suit you? |

## Keep these phrases

Is it still available?

Are bills included?

Could I arrange a viewing?

## Words to know

| | |
|---|---|
| **rent** | money paid regularly to use a property |
| **furnished** | provided with furniture |
| **separate** | not included with something else |
| **viewing** | a visit to look at a property |

### Your turn / 2 minutes

A: ask about a room and request a viewing. B: give invented details about rent and facilities.

**Change it:** Ask whether the kitchen is shared.

SELF-CHECK I made my request clear / I responded / I checked details

# Food & drink



## In this chapter

13 Booking a restaurant table

14 Ordering a meal

15 Explaining a food allergy

16 Ordering at a café

17 A problem with an order

18 Asking for the bill

Look at the drawing. Where are the people? What might they say first?

# 13 Booking a restaurant table



GOAL Reserve a table and explain what your group needs.

## The conversation

| | |
|---|---|
| **Customer** | Hello. Could I book a table for four this evening? |
| **Host** | Certainly. What time would you like? |
| **Customer** | At seven thirty, if possible. Do you have a quiet table? |
| **Host** | We have one away from the entrance. Would that be suitable? |
| **Customer** | Yes, thank you. Please book it under the name Noor. |
| **Host** | That is four people at seven thirty. We look forward to seeing you. |

## Keep these phrases

A table for four, please.

Do you have a quiet table?

Please book it under ...

## Words to know

| | |
|---|---|
| **table** | a place to sit and eat |
| **entrance** | the place where you enter |
| **suitable** | right for your needs |
| **reserve** | to arrange to keep something for you |

### Your turn / 2 minutes

A: book for a group and make one request. B: offer a time and repeat the details.

**Change it:** Change the number of people and ask for a high chair.

SELF-CHECK I made my request clear / I responded / I checked details

# 14 Ordering a meal



GOAL Choose a main dish, a side and a drink.

## The conversation

| | |
|---|---|
| **Server** | Are you ready to order, or would you like a few more minutes? |
| **Customer** | I am ready. I would like the grilled chicken, please. |
| **Server** | Would you like rice or potatoes with that? |
| **Customer** | Rice, please. Could I have the sauce on the side? |
| **Server** | Of course. What would you like to drink? |
| **Customer** | Still water, please. That is all for now. Thank you. |

## Keep these phrases

I would like the ..., please.

Could I have the sauce on the side?

That is all for now.

## Words to know

| | |
|---|---|
| **grilled** | cooked using direct heat |
| **side dish** | a smaller dish served with a main dish |
| **sauce** | a liquid served with food |
| **still water** | water without bubbles |

### Your turn / 2 minutes

A: take an order and offer a side. B: order a meal, make one request and choose a drink.

**Change it:** Order a vegetarian dish instead.

SELF-CHECK I made my request clear / I responded / I checked details

# 15 Explaining a food allergy



GOAL Clearly explain an allergy and ask staff to check ingredients.

## The conversation

| | |
|---|---|
| **Customer** | Before I order, I need to tell you that I have a nut allergy. |
| **Server** | Thank you for telling me. Which dish are you interested in? |
| **Customer** | The vegetable pasta. Does it contain any nuts? |
| **Server** | I need to check the ingredients and preparation with the kitchen. |
| **Customer** | Please also check whether it could come into contact with nuts. |
| **Server** | I will ask the chef and explain what we can confirm before you decide. |

## Keep these phrases

I have a … allergy.

Does it contain …?

Could you check with the kitchen?

## Words to know

| | |
|---|---|
| **allergy** | a harmful reaction to a particular substance |
| **ingredient** | one of the foods used in a dish |
| **contain** | to have something inside |
| **preparation** | the way food is made |

### Your turn / 2 minutes

A: explain an allergy and ask two questions. B: check details without promising something you cannot confirm.

**Change it:** Practise asking about milk or eggs.

SELF-CHECK I made my request clear / I responded / I checked details

# 16 Ordering at a café



GOAL Order a drink and answer questions about size and takeaway.

## The conversation

| | |
|---|---|
| **Customer** | Could I have a latte, please? |
| **Barista** | Of course. Small or large? |
| **Customer** | Small, please. Do you have oat milk? |
| **Barista** | Yes, we do. Is that to have here or to take away? |
| **Customer** | To take away, please. Could you make it without added sugar? |
| **Barista** | Certainly. One small oat-milk latte, without added sugar. |

## Keep these phrases

Could I have a ...?

To take away, please.

Without added sugar, please.

## Words to know

| | |
|---|---|
| **latte** | coffee made with a lot of milk |
| **oat milk** | a plant drink made from oats |
| **take away** | to take food or drink with you |
| **added sugar** | sugar put into a food or drink |

### Your turn / 2 minutes

A: order a drink with two preferences. B: ask about size and whether it is to take away.

**Change it:** Change the order to tea or hot chocolate.

SELF-CHECK I made my request clear / I responded / I checked details

# 17 A problem with an order



GOAL Explain an order mistake politely and ask for a correction.

## The conversation

| | |
|---|---|
| **Customer** | Excuse me. I think there has been a mistake with my order. |
| **Server** | I am sorry. What did you order? |
| **Customer** | I ordered vegetable soup, but this looks like chicken soup. |
| **Server** | Let me check. You are right. I will bring the correct dish. |
| **Customer** | Thank you. Could you tell me how long it will take? |
| **Server** | I will check with the kitchen and come straight back to you. |

## Keep these phrases

I think there has been a mistake.

I ordered ..., but this is ...

How long will it take?

## Words to know

| | |
|---|---|
| **order** | the food or drink you ask for |
| **mistake** | something done incorrectly |
| **correct** | right or accurate |
| **dish** | food prepared in a particular way |

### Your turn / 2 minutes

A: explain what you ordered and what arrived. B: apologise, check and offer to correct it.

**Change it:** Change the problem to a missing drink.

SELF-CHECK I made my request clear / I responded / I checked details

# 18 Asking for the bill



GOAL Request the bill, check an item and pay.

## The conversation

| | |
|---|---|
| **Customer** | Could we have the bill, please? |
| **Server** | Certainly. Here you are. |
| **Customer** | Excuse me. Could you explain this charge? |
| **Server** | That is for the extra side dish you ordered. |
| **Customer** | I see. Can we pay separately? |
| **Server** | Yes. Tell me which items each person is paying for. |

## Keep these phrases

Could we have the bill, please?

Could you explain this charge?

Can we pay separately?

## Words to know

| | |
|---|---|
| **separately** | one person or thing at a time |
| **item** | one thing on a list |
| **extra** | in addition to the usual amount |
| **total** | the full amount |

### Your turn / 2 minutes

A: ask for the bill and question one item. B: explain the item and ask how the group will pay.

**Change it:** Ask to pay together and request a receipt.

SELF-CHECK I made my request clear / I responded / I checked details

# Shopping & money



## In this chapter

19 Buying clothes

20 Returning an item

21 At the supermarket

22 Buying a phone or an electronic item

23 At a bank or currency exchange

24 When a card payment does not work

Look at the drawing. Where are the people? What might they say first?

# 19 Buying clothes



GOAL Ask for a size, try something on and check the fit.

## The conversation

| | |
|---|---|
| **Customer** | Excuse me. Do you have this shirt in a medium? |
| **Assistant** | Yes. Would you like the blue one or the white one? |
| **Customer** | The blue one, please. May I try it on? |
| **Assistant** | Of course. The fitting rooms are at the back. |
| **Customer** | It fits well. How much is it? |
| **Assistant** | It is twenty-five. Would you like to take it? |

## Keep these phrases

Do you have this in a medium?

May I try it on?

It fits well.

## Words to know

| | |
|---|---|
| **size** | how large or small something is |
| **medium** | a size between small and large |
| **fitting room** | a room for trying on clothes |
| **fit** | to be the right size |

### Your turn / 2 minutes

A: ask for clothing in a size and colour. B: offer an option and explain where to try it on.

**Change it:** Say it is too small and ask for a larger size.

SELF-CHECK I made my request clear / I responded / I checked details

# 20 Returning an item



GOAL Explain why you want to return something and ask about options.

## The conversation

| | |
|---|---|
| **Customer** | Hello. I bought this bag yesterday, but the zip is broken. |
| **Assistant** | I am sorry about that. Do you have your receipt? |
| **Customer** | Yes, here it is. Could I exchange it? |
| **Assistant** | Let me check our policy and whether the same bag is in stock. |
| **Customer** | If it is not available, what other options do I have? |
| **Assistant** | I will explain the available options before you decide. |

## Keep these phrases

I bought this yesterday.

Could I exchange it?

What other options do I have?

## Words to know

| | |
|---|---|
| **zip** | a fastener with two rows of teeth |
| **exchange** | to replace one item with another |
| **in stock** | available in the shop |
| **refund** | money returned after a purchase |

### Your turn / 2 minutes

A: explain a problem with an item. B: ask for proof of purchase and discuss possible next steps.

**Change it:** Ask about a refund rather than an exchange.

SELF-CHECK I made my request clear / I responded / I checked details

# 21 At the supermarket



GOAL Find an item and ask about quantity or product details.

## The conversation

| | |
|---|---|
| **Shopper** | Excuse me. Where can I find rice? |
| **Assistant** | In aisle five, next to the pasta. |
| **Shopper** | Thank you. Do you have a small bag? |
| **Assistant** | Yes. There are one-kilo bags on the lower shelf. |
| **Shopper** | Great. Is there a price label for this one? |
| **Assistant** | It is just below the product. I can check it for you. |

## Keep these phrases

Where can I find ...?

Do you have a smaller pack?

Could you check the price?

## Words to know

| | |
|---|---|
| **aisle** | a passage between shop shelves |
| **shelf** | a flat surface for storing goods |
| **pack** | a container or group of items |
| **label** | a small piece showing information |

### Your turn / 2 minutes

A: find two products and ask about pack size. B: give aisle numbers and shelf locations.

**Change it:** Ask for a product without added sugar.

SELF-CHECK I made my request clear / I responded / I checked details

# 22 Buying a phone or an electronic item



GOAL Compare products and ask about features and warranty.

## The conversation

| | |
|---|---|
| **Customer** | I am looking for a phone with a good battery. |
| **Assistant** | What is your budget? |
| **Customer** | Around two hundred. Could you compare these two models? |
| **Assistant** | This one has more storage. That one is lighter. |
| **Customer** | Is a charger included, and what does the warranty cover? |
| **Assistant** | Let us check the box contents and the written warranty details. |

## Keep these phrases

I am looking for ...

Could you compare these two models?

What does the warranty cover?

## Words to know

| | |
|---|---|
| **budget** | the amount you plan to spend |
| **storage** | space for keeping digital files |
| **charger** | a device that supplies power to a battery |
| **warranty** | a written promise about faults and repairs |

### Your turn / 2 minutes

A: explain two needs and a budget. B: compare two imaginary products and check included items.

**Change it:** Compare headphones or two laptops instead.

SELF-CHECK I made my request clear / I responded / I checked details

# 23 At a bank or currency exchange



GOAL Ask about an exchange rate, fees and the final amount.

## The conversation

| | |
|---|---|
| **Customer** | Hello. I would like to exchange some money. |
| **Clerk** | Certainly. Which currency do you have, and which do you need? |
| **Customer** | I have euros and I need pounds. What rate are you offering? |
| **Clerk** | Let me show you the current rate and any fees. |
| **Customer** | Before we continue, how much would I receive in total? |
| **Clerk** | I will write the final amount here for you to check. |

## Keep these phrases

I would like to exchange some money.

Are there any fees?

How much would I receive in total?

## Words to know

| | |
|---|---|
| **currency** | the money used in a country |
| **exchange rate** | the value of one currency in another |
| **fee** | money charged for a service |
| **amount** | a quantity of money |

### Your turn / 2 minutes

A: ask about exchanging money and all fees. B: invent practice figures and explain the final amount.

**Change it:** Ask for some smaller notes.

SELF-CHECK I made my request clear / I responded / I checked details

# 24 When a card payment does not work



GOAL Handle a payment problem without sharing private codes.

## The conversation

| | |
|---|---|
| **Cashier** | I am sorry. The payment has not gone through. |
| **Customer** | Could we try once more, please? |
| **Cashier** | Certainly. Please follow the instructions on the card machine. |
| **Customer** | It still is not working. Can I use another card? |
| **Cashier** | Yes, or you can pay in cash if you prefer. |
| **Customer** | I will use this card instead. May I have the receipt when it is complete? |

## Keep these phrases

The payment has not gone through.

Can I use another card?

May I have the receipt?

## Words to know

| | |
|---|---|
| **payment** | money given for something |
| **cashier** | a person who takes payments |
| **card machine** | a device used for card payments |
| **cash** | money in notes and coins |

### Your turn / 2 minutes

A: explain that a payment did not work. B: ask about another payment method and request a receipt.

**Change it:** Practise the same situation at a café.

SELF-CHECK I made my request clear / I responded / I checked details

# Health & getting help



## In this chapter

25 Making a medical appointment

26 At hospital reception

27 Describing symptoms to a doctor

28 Asking a pharmacist for an explanation

29 At the dentist

30 Calling for urgent help

Look at the drawing. Where are the people? What might they say first?

# 25 Making a medical appointment



GOAL Request an appointment and confirm its details.

## The conversation

| | |
|---|---|
| **Patient** | Hello. I would like to make an appointment with a doctor. |
| **Receptionist** | Certainly. Is this your first visit to the clinic? |
| **Patient** | Yes, it is. Do you have an appointment tomorrow morning? |
| **Receptionist** | We have one at ten fifteen. May I take your name? |
| **Patient** | Sami Ahmed. What should I bring with me? |
| **Receptionist** | Please bring your ID and any documents our registration team requests. |

## Keep these phrases

I would like to make an appointment.

Is there anything available tomorrow?

What should I bring with me?

## Words to know

| | |
|---|---|
| **appointment** | an arranged time to meet someone |
| **clinic** | a place where people receive healthcare |
| **first visit** | the first time you attend a place |
| **registration** | recording your details officially |

### Your turn / 2 minutes

A: request a routine appointment and ask what to bring. B: offer two times and confirm a name.

**Change it:** Ask to change an existing appointment.

SELF-CHECK I made my request clear / I responded / I checked details

# 26 At hospital reception



GOAL Check in for an appointment and find the correct waiting area.

## The conversation

| | |
|---|---|
| **Patient** | Good morning. I have an appointment with Dr Khan at eleven. |
| **Receptionist** | Good morning. Could you confirm your full name? |
| **Patient** | Noor Salim. This is my appointment message. |
| **Receptionist** | Thank you. Please take a seat in waiting area B. |
| **Patient** | How will I know when it is my turn? |
| **Receptionist** | A member of staff will call your name. Let us know if you need assistance. |

## Keep these phrases

I have an appointment with ...

Where should I wait?

How will I know when it is my turn?

## Words to know

| | |
|---|---|
| **reception** | the place where visitors are welcomed |
| **waiting area** | a place to sit until you are called |
| **turn** | your time to be served |
| **assistance** | help |

### Your turn / 2 minutes

A: arrive for an appointment and ask where to wait. B: check a name and explain what happens next.

**Change it:** Ask for help finding the lift or a wheelchair-accessible route.

SELF-CHECK I made my request clear / I responded / I checked details

# 27 Describing symptoms to a doctor



GOAL Describe how you feel and answer basic follow-up questions.

## The conversation

| | |
|---|---|
| **Doctor** | What brings you in today? |
| **Patient** | I have a sore throat and I have been coughing. |
| **Doctor** | When did the symptoms start? |
| **Patient** | Two days ago. I also feel more tired than usual. |
| **Doctor** | Are you taking any medicines, and do you have any allergies? |
| **Patient** | I brought a list of my medicines. I am not sure about the allergy question. |

## Keep these phrases

I have a sore throat.

The symptoms started ...

Could you explain that in simpler words?

## Words to know

| | |
|---|---|
| **symptom** | a sign of an illness or health problem |
| **sore throat** | pain or irritation in the throat |
| **cough** | to push air suddenly from your throat |
| **medicine** | a substance used in healthcare |

### Your turn / 2 minutes

A: ask when symptoms began and about medicines. B: use imaginary symptoms and ask for clarification if needed.

**Change it:** Practise explaining a headache without guessing its cause.

SELF-CHECK I made my request clear / I responded / I checked details

# 28 Asking a pharmacist for an explanation



GOAL Ask for help understanding a medicine label.

## The conversation

| | |
|---|---|
| **Customer** | Could you explain the instructions on this label, please? |
| **Pharmacist** | Of course. Is this the medicine prescribed for you? |
| **Customer** | Yes. I want to be sure I understand when to take it. |
| **Pharmacist** | Let us read the prescription instructions together. What part is unclear? |
| **Customer** | This part about food. Could you write the explanation down? |
| **Pharmacist** | Certainly. Then you can repeat the instructions back so we can check your understanding. |

## Keep these phrases

Could you explain this label?

What does this instruction mean?

Could you write it down?

## Words to know

| | |
|---|---|
| **pharmacist** | a professional who supplies and explains medicines |
| **prescription** | written instructions for a medicine |
| **label** | printed information on a container |
| **instructions** | directions explaining what to do |

### Your turn / 2 minutes

A: ask about a fictional label. B: practise asking what is unclear; use no real doses or treatment advice.

**Change it:** Ask how to store the medicine and whom to contact with questions.

SELF-CHECK I made my request clear / I responded / I checked details

# 29 At the dentist



GOAL Explain a dental concern and ask what will happen next.

## The conversation

| | |
|---|---|
| **Dentist** | How can I help you today? |
| **Patient** | One of my teeth hurts when I eat. |
| **Dentist** | Could you show me which one? |
| **Patient** | This one, on the lower left. I am a little nervous. |
| **Dentist** | Thank you for telling me. I will explain each step before we begin. |
| **Patient** | Could we agree on a signal if I need a break? |

## Keep these phrases

This tooth hurts.

I am a little nervous.

Could we agree on a signal?

## Words to know

| | |
|---|---|
| **tooth** | a hard part inside the mouth used for biting |
| **lower** | closer to the bottom |
| **nervous** | worried or uneasy |
| **signal** | a gesture used to communicate |

### Your turn / 2 minutes

A: ask which tooth is uncomfortable. B: describe its location and ask the dentist to explain the next step.

**Change it:** Ask for a short break during a pretend appointment.

SELF-CHECK I made my request clear / I responded / I checked details

# 30 Calling for urgent help



GOAL Give your location and describe an urgent situation clearly.

## The conversation

| | |
|---|---|
| **Caller** | I need an ambulance. Someone has collapsed. |
| **Operator** | What is the exact location? |
| **Caller** | The entrance to the City Library on Park Road. |
| **Operator** | Tell me what happened and whether the person is responding. |
| **Caller** | He fell a moment ago. He is not answering when I speak to him. |
| **Operator** | Stay on the line and follow my instructions. I will ask you some more questions. |

## Keep these phrases

I need an ambulance.

The exact location is ...

Could you repeat the instruction?

## Words to know

| | |
|---|---|
| **ambulance** | a vehicle for urgent medical transport |
| **location** | the place where something is |
| **respond** | to react or answer |
| **operator** | a person who handles telephone calls |

### Your turn / 2 minutes

A: describe a fictional incident and its exact location. B: ask clear questions. Practise speaking calmly.

**Change it:** Change the location to a hotel lobby. This is language practice, not first-aid training.

SELF-CHECK I made my request clear / I responded / I checked details

# Everyday services



## In this chapter

31 Sending a parcel

32 Choosing a mobile plan

33 Reporting an internet problem

34 At a hair salon or barber shop

35 Arranging a repair

36 Reporting lost property

Look at the drawing. Where are the people? What might they say first?

# 31 Sending a parcel



GOAL Ask about delivery time, cost and tracking.

## The conversation

| | |
|---|---|
| **Customer** | I would like to send this parcel to Manchester, please. |
| **Clerk** | Certainly. Please put it on the scale. What is inside? |
| **Customer** | Some books. Is there a tracked delivery option? |
| **Clerk** | Yes. I can show you the available services and estimated delivery times. |
| **Customer** | Thank you. Could you check that the address is clear? |
| **Clerk** | Of course. Please also add the sender's address here. |

## Keep these phrases

I would like to send this parcel.

Is tracking available?

What is the estimated delivery time?

## Words to know

| | |
|---|---|
| **parcel** | an object wrapped for sending |
| **tracking** | checking where a delivery is |
| **sender** | the person who sends something |
| **delivery** | taking something to its destination |

### Your turn / 2 minutes

A: send a parcel and ask about tracking. B: ask about contents and offer two imaginary services.

**Change it:** Send a letter instead of a parcel.

SELF-CHECK I made my request clear / I responded / I checked details

# 32 Choosing a mobile plan



GOAL Explain your needs and ask about limits and extra charges.

## The conversation

| | |
|---|---|
| **Customer** | I need a mobile plan for a short visit. What are my options? |
| **Assistant** | How long are you staying, and do you mainly need calls or data? |
| **Customer** | Two weeks. Mainly data, with a few local calls. |
| **Assistant** | Let us compare the allowance, expiry date and total price of these plans. |
| **Customer** | Does either plan renew automatically? |
| **Assistant** | I will check that and show you how renewal works before you choose. |

## Keep these phrases

I mainly need data.

Are there any extra charges?

Does it renew automatically?

## Words to know

| | |
|---|---|
| **plan** | a package of phone services |
| **data** | internet use on a phone |
| **allowance** | the amount included in a plan |
| **renew** | to start a service period again |

### Your turn / 2 minutes

A: describe a short visit and your phone needs. B: compare two made-up plans without hiding extra costs.

**Change it:** Ask whether your phone can use an eSIM.

SELF-CHECK I made my request clear / I responded / I checked details

# 33 Reporting an internet problem



GOAL Explain a connection problem and follow a support conversation.

## The conversation

| | |
|---|---|
| **Customer** | Hello. My internet connection has stopped working. |
| **Support agent** | I can help you check it. When did the problem start? |
| **Customer** | About an hour ago. None of my devices can connect. |
| **Support agent** | Thank you. Could you describe the lights on your router? |
| **Customer** | The power light is on, but the internet light is red. |
| **Support agent** | I will check for a service issue and guide you through the next step. |

## Keep these phrases

My connection has stopped working.

None of my devices can connect.

Could you guide me through it?

## Words to know

| | |
|---|---|
| **connection** | a link to a network |
| **device** | a piece of electronic equipment |
| **router** | a device that connects a network |
| **support** | help with using a service |

### Your turn / 2 minutes

A: describe a connection problem and when it began. B: ask questions and explain one simple pretend check.

**Change it:** Ask the agent to slow down and repeat a step.

SELF-CHECK I made my request clear / I responded / I checked details

# 34 At a hair salon or barber shop



GOAL Explain the haircut you want and check the plan first.

## The conversation

| | |
|---|---|
| **Customer** | Hello. Do I need an appointment for a haircut? |
| **Hairdresser** | We can see you in fifteen minutes. What would you like? |
| **Customer** | Just a trim, please. I would like to keep most of the length. |
| **Hairdresser** | About this much off the ends? |
| **Customer** | Yes. Could you show me before you cut any more? |
| **Hairdresser** | Of course. We will check the length together first. |

## Keep these phrases

Just a trim, please.

I would like to keep the length.

Could you show me first?

## Words to know

| | |
|---|---|
| **haircut** | a style made by cutting hair |
| **trim** | cutting a small amount from the ends |
| **length** | how long something is |
| **ends** | the tips of something |

### Your turn / 2 minutes

A: explain a haircut and a limit. B: confirm how much to cut before pretending to begin.

**Change it:** Use a picture to describe the style you want.

SELF-CHECK I made my request clear / I responded / I checked details

# 35 Arranging a repair



GOAL Explain a fault and ask for an estimate before work starts.

## The conversation

| | |
|---|---|
| **Customer** | My washing machine makes a loud noise and stops halfway through. |
| **Technician** | When did you first notice the problem? |
| **Customer** | Yesterday. Could you come and inspect it? |
| **Technician** | I have an appointment available tomorrow afternoon. |
| **Customer** | What is the inspection fee? Please give me an estimate before doing repairs. |
| **Technician** | Certainly. I will explain the fault and the cost before you decide. |

## Keep these phrases

It stops halfway through.

What is the inspection fee?

Please give me an estimate first.

## Words to know

| | |
|---|---|
| **fault** | a problem that stops something working properly |
| **inspect** | to check carefully |
| **repair** | to make something work again |
| **estimate** | an approximate cost |

### Your turn / 2 minutes

A: describe a household fault and request a visit. B: arrange a time and explain how you will confirm the cost.

**Change it:** Change the appliance to a fridge or a laptop.

SELF-CHECK I made my request clear / I responded / I checked details

# 36 Reporting lost property



GOAL Describe a missing item and explain where you last saw it.

## The conversation

| | |
|---|---|
| **Visitor** | Excuse me. I think I left my wallet in this building. |
| **Staff member** | I can check lost property. Could you describe it? |
| **Visitor** | It is a small brown wallet. I last saw it near the café. |
| **Staff member** | When were you there? |
| **Visitor** | About half an hour ago. What should I do if it is handed in? |
| **Staff member** | Please leave a contact number. We will explain how to identify and collect it. |

## Keep these phrases

I think I left my … here.

It is a small brown …

Where can I report lost property?

## Words to know

| | |
|---|---|
| **wallet** | a small holder for money and cards |
| **lost property** | items found and kept for their owners |
| **hand in** | to give something to responsible staff |
| **identify** | to show which thing belongs to you |

### Your turn / 2 minutes

A: report a missing item with three details. B: ask when and where it was last seen.

**Change it:** Describe a bag, a coat or a pair of glasses.

SELF-CHECK I made my request clear / I responded / I checked details

# Study & work



## In this chapter

37 Asking about a course

38 Asking for help in class

39 At the library

40 Planning a group project

41 At a job interview

42 Arranging or changing a meeting

Look at the drawing. Where are the people? What might they say first?

# 37 Asking about a course



GOAL Ask about a course level, schedule and registration.

## The conversation

| | |
|---|---|
| **Learner** | Hello. I am interested in your evening English course. |
| **Course adviser** | Welcome. Have you studied English before? |
| **Learner** | A little. How do I know which level is suitable for me? |
| **Course adviser** | We can explain the level check and help you choose a class. |
| **Learner** | Which days are the classes, and how do I register? |
| **Course adviser** | Here is the timetable and the registration form. Let us go through them. |

## Keep these phrases

I am interested in …

Which level is suitable for me?

How do I register?

## Words to know

| | |
|---|---|
| **course** | a series of lessons on a subject |
| **level** | a stage of learning or ability |
| **timetable** | a list of class times |
| **register** | to sign up for something |

### Your turn / 2 minutes

A: ask about a course and its timetable. B: explain a made-up course and how to find the right level.

**Change it:** Ask about an online or weekend class.

SELF-CHECK I made my request clear / I responded / I checked details

# 38 Asking for help in class



GOAL Ask for repetition, an example and a clearer instruction.

## The conversation

| | |
|---|---|
| **Student** | Sorry, I did not catch the last instruction. Could you repeat it? |
| **Teacher** | Of course. Work with a partner and write three questions. |
| **Student** | Do we write questions about the picture or about ourselves? |
| **Teacher** | About the picture. For example, Where is the woman going? |
| **Student** | I understand now. Do we answer the questions too? |
| **Teacher** | Yes. Ask your partner, listen to the answer and then swap roles. |

## Keep these phrases

Could you repeat the instruction?

Could you give an example?

Do you mean ...?

## Words to know

| | |
|---|---|
| **instruction** | something that tells you what to do |
| **partner** | a person working with you |
| **example** | something that shows how to do a task |
| **swap roles** | to exchange parts in an activity |

### Your turn / 2 minutes

A: ask one clarification question and repeat what you will do. B: explain a short classroom task.

**Change it:** Ask for more time or for the meaning of a word.

SELF-CHECK I made my request clear / I responded / I checked details

# 39 At the library



GOAL Find a suitable book and ask about borrowing it.

## The conversation

| | |
|---|---|
| **Reader** | Could you help me find an easy English story? |
| **Librarian** | Certainly. What kinds of stories do you enjoy? |
| **Reader** | Short stories about everyday life. I am still a beginner. |
| **Librarian** | These graded readers might suit you. Try reading a page first. |
| **Reader** | This one looks good. How long can I borrow it for? |
| **Librarian** | Let me check the loan period and show you the return date. |

## Keep these phrases

Could you help me find ...?

I am still a beginner.

When should I return it?

## Words to know

| | |
|---|---|
| **graded reader** | a book written for a particular language level |
| **borrow** | to use something and give it back later |
| **loan period** | the time you may keep a borrowed item |
| **return date** | the day an item must be given back |

### Your turn / 2 minutes

A: ask for a book that matches your interests. B: suggest a type of book and explain an invented loan period.

**Change it:** Ask whether you can renew the loan.

SELF-CHECK I made my request clear / I responded / I checked details

# 40 Planning a group project



GOAL Divide tasks, agree on deadlines and confirm the next step.

## The conversation

| | |
|---|---|
| **Student A** | We need to prepare a presentation about our town. How shall we divide the work? |
| **Student B** | I can collect information. Would you like to prepare the slides? |
| **Student A** | Yes. When can you send me your notes? |
| **Student B** | By Tuesday evening. Could we review the slides together on Wednesday? |
| **Student A** | That works for me. Let us practise the talk after the review. |
| **Student B** | Agreed. I will send a short checklist so we both know our tasks. |

## Keep these phrases

How shall we divide the work?

When can you send your part?

That works for me.

## Words to know

| | |
|---|---|
| **presentation** | a talk that shares information |
| **slide** | one page of a presentation |
| **deadline** | the latest time to finish something |
| **checklist** | a list for checking completed tasks |

### Your turn / 2 minutes

A: suggest a project and two tasks. B: choose a task. Agree on a deadline and a rehearsal time.

**Change it:** One person needs extra time. Agree on a revised plan.

SELF-CHECK I made my request clear / I responded / I checked details

# 41 At a job interview



GOAL Introduce yourself and support a skill with an example.

## The conversation

| | |
|---|---|
| **Interviewer** | Please tell me a little about yourself. |
| **Applicant** | I am a college student. I enjoy organising tasks and helping people. |
| **Interviewer** | Can you give an example of working in a team? |
| **Applicant** | In a class project, I made a checklist and helped our group finish on time. |
| **Interviewer** | What would you like to improve? |
| **Applicant** | I want to speak more confidently. I practise short presentations every week. |

## Keep these phrases

I am good at ...

For example, ...

I am working on improving ...

## Words to know

| | |
|---|---|
| **applicant** | a person asking to be considered for a job |
| **strength** | something you do well |
| **team** | people working together |
| **confidently** | with belief in your ability |

### Your turn / 2 minutes

A: ask about one skill and one example. B: answer truthfully using a study, volunteer or work experience.

**Change it:** Add one question about the role at the end.

SELF-CHECK I made my request clear / I responded / I checked details

# 42 Arranging or changing a meeting



GOAL Suggest a time and politely rearrange a meeting.

## The conversation

| | |
|---|---|
| **Colleague A** | Could we meet on Tuesday to discuss the project? |
| **Colleague B** | Yes. Would ten o'clock suit you? |
| **Colleague A** | I have a class then. Could we make it eleven thirty instead? |
| **Colleague B** | That should be fine. Shall we meet in the library? |
| **Colleague A** | Yes, near the entrance. I will send a message to confirm. |
| **Colleague B** | Great. Please include what we need to bring. |

## Keep these phrases

Would ten o'clock suit you?

Could we make it … instead?

I will send a message to confirm.

## Words to know

| | |
|---|---|
| **meeting** | an arranged time to talk or work together |
| **discuss** | to talk about something |
| **reschedule** | to arrange a new time |
| **confirm** | to make an arrangement certain |

### Your turn / 2 minutes

A: propose a meeting. B: explain a time conflict. Agree on a new time, place and purpose.

**Change it:** Move the meeting online and ask for the link.

SELF-CHECK I made my request clear / I responded / I checked details

# Friends & social life



## In this chapter

43 Meeting someone new

44 Making a phone call and leaving a message

45 Inviting someone and responding

46 Apologising and putting things right

47 Asking permission and borrowing something

48 Making plans and sharing preferences

Look at the drawing. Where are the people? What might they say first?

# 43 Meeting someone new



GOAL Introduce yourself and keep a short conversation going.

## The conversation

| | |
|---|---|
| **Person A** | Hello. I do not think we have met. My name is Ali. |
| **Person B** | Hi, Ali. I am Daniel. Nice to meet you. |
| **Person A** | Nice to meet you too. Is this your first time at this workshop? |
| **Person B** | Yes. I joined because I want to improve my English. What about you? |
| **Person A** | The same, really. I especially want to practise speaking. |
| **Person B** | Then perhaps we can work together in the next activity. |

## Keep these phrases

I do not think we have met.

Nice to meet you.

What about you?

## Words to know

| | |
|---|---|
| **introduce** | to tell someone who you are |
| **workshop** | a session for learning through activities |
| **especially** | more than other things |
| **perhaps** | possibly |

### Your turn / 2 minutes

A: introduce yourself at a new event. B: respond and ask one related question. Find a shared interest.

**Change it:** Meet at a course, a workplace or a community event.

SELF-CHECK I made my request clear / I responded / I checked details

# 44 Making a phone call and leaving a message



GOAL Ask for someone and leave a clear message.

## The conversation

| | |
|---|---|
| **Caller** | Good morning. Could I speak to Ms Noor, please? |
| **Receptionist** | She is not available at the moment. Would you like to leave a message? |
| **Caller** | Yes. This is Huda Salim calling about tomorrow's meeting. |
| **Receptionist** | What would you like me to tell her? |
| **Caller** | Please ask her to call me back. I will give you my contact number. |
| **Receptionist** | Certainly. I will read the number back to check I have it correctly. |

## Keep these phrases

Could I speak to ..., please?

Could I leave a message?

Please ask her to call me back.

## Words to know

| | |
|---|---|
| **available** | free to speak or help |
| **message** | information left for someone |
| **call back** | to return a phone call |
| **contact number** | a number used to reach someone |

### Your turn / 2 minutes

A: call for someone who is unavailable. B: take a message and repeat a made-up number carefully.

**Change it:** Practise asking the caller to spell a name.

SELF-CHECK I made my request clear / I responded / I checked details

# 45 Inviting someone and responding



GOAL Invite a friend and accept or decline politely.

## The conversation

| | |
|---|---|
| **Friend A** | Would you like to come over for dinner on Friday? |
| **Friend B** | That is very kind of you. I would love to. What time? |
| **Friend A** | Around seven. Does that work for you? |
| **Friend B** | Yes. Shall I bring anything? |
| **Friend A** | Just yourself. Please let me know if there is any food you cannot eat. |
| **Friend B** | Thank you. I will message you the details. See you on Friday. |

## Keep these phrases

Would you like to ...?

I would love to, thank you.

I am sorry, I cannot make it.

## Words to know

| | |
|---|---|
| **invite** | to ask someone to join an event |
| **come over** | to visit someone at home |
| **decline** | to politely say no |
| **make it** | to be able to attend |

### Your turn / 2 minutes

A: invite a friend and give a time. B: accept and ask one question. Then repeat with a polite refusal.

**Change it:** Decline and suggest a different day.

SELF-CHECK I made my request clear / I responded / I checked details

# 46 Apologising and putting things right



GOAL Apologise, explain briefly and offer a solution.

## The conversation

| | |
|---|---|
| **Friend A** | I am sorry I am late. I got on the wrong bus. |
| **Friend B** | Thanks for letting me know. Are you nearby now? |
| **Friend A** | Yes, I am about ten minutes away. I should have messaged earlier. |
| **Friend B** | All right. I will wait inside the café. |
| **Friend A** | Thank you for waiting. I will send you an update if anything changes. |
| **Friend B** | That is fine. See you soon. |

## Keep these phrases

I am sorry I am late.

I should have let you know earlier.

How can I put this right?

## Words to know

| | |
|---|---|
| **apologise** | to say you are sorry |
| **nearby** | not far away |
| **update** | new information about a situation |
| **delay** | a situation that makes something late |

### Your turn / 2 minutes

A: apologise for being late and give an arrival estimate. B: respond and agree on where to wait.

**Change it:** Apologise for returning a borrowed book late.

SELF-CHECK I made my request clear / I responded / I checked details

# 47 Asking permission and borrowing something



GOAL Ask permission and agree on when to return an item.

## The conversation

| | |
|---|---|
| **Person A** | Excuse me. May I sit here? |
| **Person B** | Yes, of course. This seat is free. |
| **Person A** | Thank you. Could I borrow a pen for a moment? |
| **Person B** | Certainly. Here you are. I will need it back before the lesson starts. |
| **Person A** | No problem. I only need to write this number. |
| **Person B** | Take your time. Let me know if you need some paper too. |

## Keep these phrases

May I sit here?

Could I borrow ...?

I will return it before ...

## Words to know

| | |
|---|---|
| **permission** | being allowed to do something |
| **borrow** | to use and then return something |
| **lend** | to give something for temporary use |
| **free seat** | a seat nobody is using |

### Your turn / 2 minutes

A: ask permission and borrow an item. B: agree or politely refuse, and explain when you need it.

**Change it:** Ask to borrow a charger, then confirm that it fits your device.

SELF-CHECK I made my request clear / I responded / I checked details

# 48 Making plans and sharing preferences



GOAL Suggest an activity, compare ideas and agree on a plan.

## The conversation

| | |
|---|---|
| **Friend A** | What would you like to do this weekend? |
| **Friend B** | How about visiting the museum? I hear there is a new exhibition. |
| **Friend A** | That sounds interesting, but I would prefer an outdoor activity. |
| **Friend B** | We could walk in the park first and visit the museum afterwards. |
| **Friend A** | Good idea. Shall we meet at the park entrance at nine? |
| **Friend B** | Yes. Let us check the weather and opening times before we go. |

## Keep these phrases

How about ...?

I would prefer ...

Shall we meet at ...?

## Words to know

| | |
|---|---|
| **prefer** | to like one option more than another |
| **outdoor** | in the open air |
| **exhibition** | a public display of art or objects |
| **afterwards** | after that |

### Your turn / 2 minutes

A: suggest an activity. B: give a different preference. Find a plan that works for both people.

**Change it:** The weather changes. Agree on an indoor alternative.

SELF-CHECK I made my request clear / I responded / I checked details

# Mix-and-match speaking challenges

### 1 / Arrival day

Check in for a flight, ask for a gate, then take a taxi to a hotel. Add one clarification question in each conversation.

### 2 / A hotel stay

Book a room, check in and report a room problem. Finish by agreeing on a next step.

### 3 / A meal out

Book a table, order a meal and check the bill. Change one item after the first attempt.

### 4 / A shopping trip

Find a product, compare two options and deal with a payment problem. Keep the conversation polite.

### 5 / Asking for help

Book a routine appointment, find the waiting area and ask a pharmacist to explain a fictional label. Do not invent clinical advice.

### 6 / College and friends

Ask about a course, plan a group project and invite a classmate to practise. Agree on a day and time.

### Partner feedback

Give one example for each: a clear request; a useful response; a successful check of meaning. Then choose one phrase to practise again.

# Build your own conversation

Place: _____

The two people: _____

What does each person need?: _____

**1. Open politely**

_____

**2. Respond naturally**

_____

**3. Make the main request**

_____

**4. Ask for a detail**

_____

**5. Answer and check meaning**

_____

**6. Offer a solution or next step**

_____

**7. Confirm the agreement**

_____

**8. Close politely**

_____

Practise twice. On the second attempt, change one detail without rewriting the whole dialogue.

# My conversation record

Mark each situation after you read it, practise it and speak without the script. Keep dates and notes in your notebook.

| No. | READ | PRACTISE | SPEAK | No. | READ | PRACTISE | SPEAK |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 01 | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | 25 | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |
| 02 | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | 26 | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |
| 03 | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | 27 | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |
| 04 | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | 28 | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |
| 05 | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | 29 | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |
| 06 | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | 30 | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |
| 07 | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | 31 | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |
| 08 | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | 32 | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |
| 09 | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | 33 | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |
| 10 | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | 34 | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |
| 11 | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | 35 | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |
| 12 | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | 36 | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |
| 13 | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | 37 | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |
| 14 | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | 38 | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |
| 15 | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | 39 | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |
| 16 | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | 40 | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |
| 17 | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | 41 | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |
| 18 | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | 42 | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |
| 19 | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | 43 | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |
| 20 | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | 44 | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |
| 21 | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | 45 | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |
| 22 | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | 46 | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |
| 23 | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | 47 | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |
| 24 | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | 48 | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |

My strongest improvement: _____

My next goal: _____

# Your next chapter

### Keep the conversations going

Choose three situations you are likely to need. Practise each with new names, places, times and preferences. Ask a partner to interrupt with a question so you learn to respond.

### A simple next-month plan

Week 1: review useful phrases.
Week 2: practise without the written dialogue.
Week 3: link two situations together.
Week 4: record a conversation and compare it with your first attempt.

### Celebrate your practice

This recognises the effort and progress of

_____

who practised the situations and completed a personal conversation task.

### I can keep learning

I can ask for help. I can check meaning. I can try again when I make a mistake.

### Date and learning partner

Date: _____
Teacher / partner: _____

This is a record of practice, not a formal language proficiency qualification.